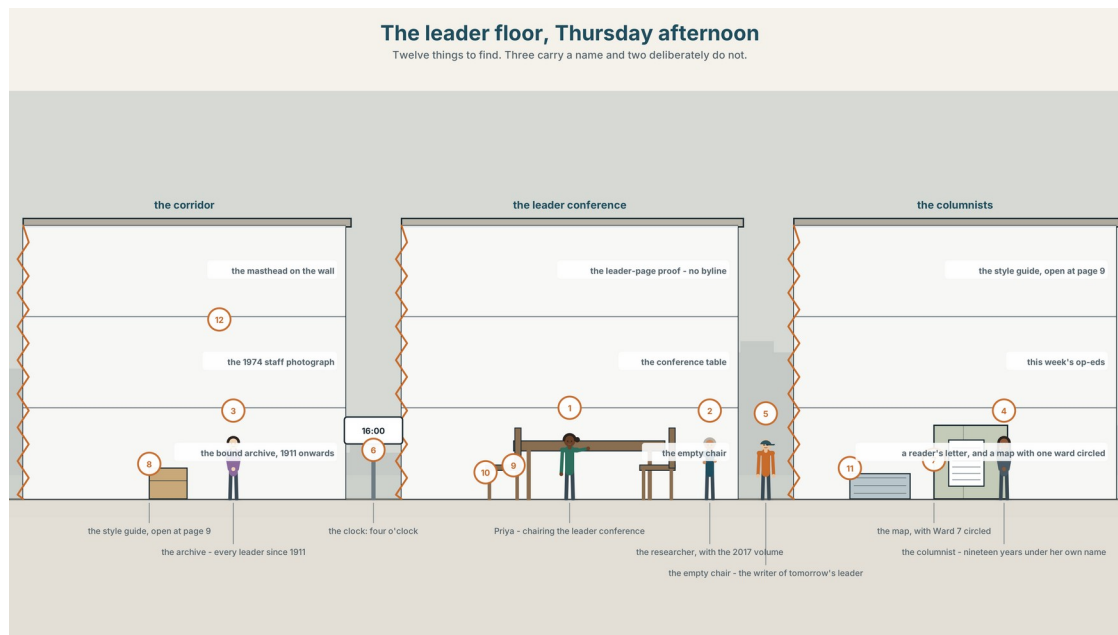


Table of Contents

B2.1 • Unit 2 • We Have Always Said

English Animated • Reading *Between Lines* • a newsroom, Toronto Student's Book pages 28–49 • 22 pp • ~11 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



{width=6.

6in}

The leader floor, Thursday afternoon — Twelve things to find. Three carry a name and two deliberately do not.

Who is "we"?

By the end of this unit you can place yourself in a text deliberately, and say who you are claiming to speak for. Two hundred words.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

An unsigned editorial that says *we have always said*, and an archive that disagrees

the perfect across every tense, as a discourse move • 28 words for voice and readership • 22 words for inclusive and exclusive reference • stress on a pronoun

Two hundred words in which the

◆ A • THE WORLD

An unsigned editorial that says *we have always said*, and an archive that disagrees

reader always knows who is speaking

0A • Find it

Find twelve things in this picture. Three of them carry somebody's name and two deliberately do not.

the masthead on the wall · a leader-page proof with no byline · a photograph of the 1974 staff · a bound archive volume · a columnist's framed first piece · a screen showing a reader comment · an empty chair at the leader conference · a style guide open at page 9 · a list of this week's op-eds · a letter from a reader · a map of the city with one ward circled · a clock

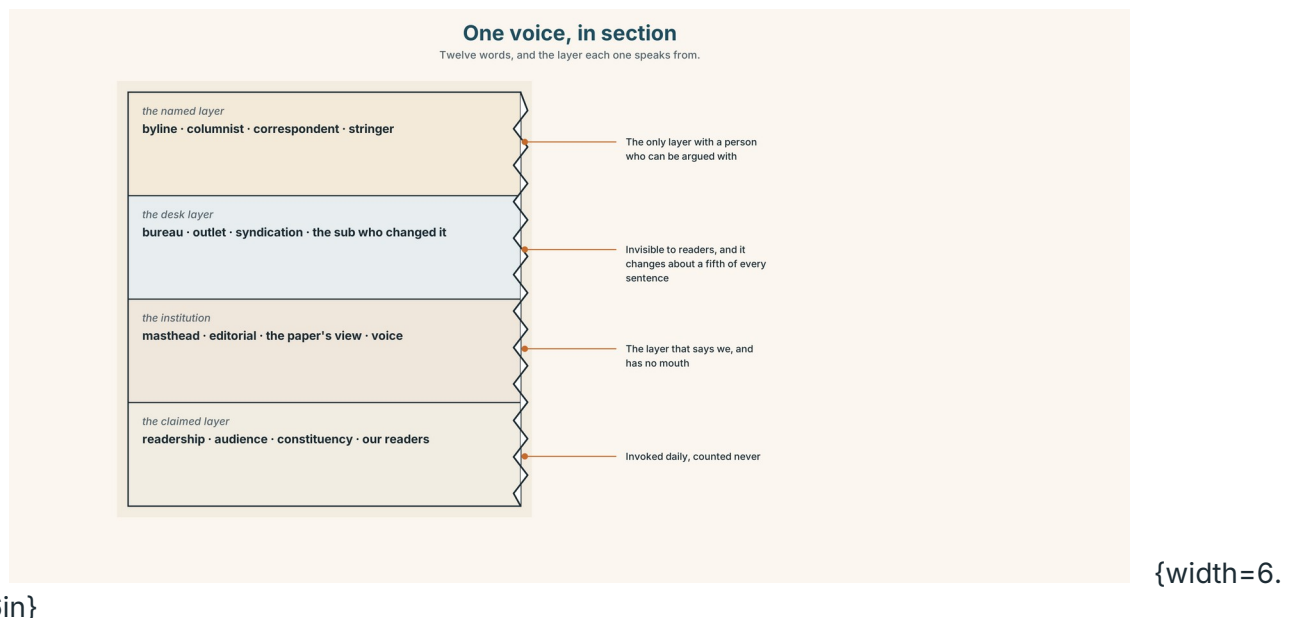
0B • Guess it

One thing in this picture is the reason another one is unsigned. Which two, and in which direction does the causation run?

0C • Say it

Record sixty seconds. Describe an opinion you hold that a group you belong to also holds. Say which parts are yours and which parts you inherited. You will record it again at the end of this unit.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM



6in}

One voice, in section — Twelve words, and the layer each one speaks from.

1A • Meet — the words of a voice

Match each word to one layer of the cutaway.

byline • masthead • readership • constituency • columnist • editorial • outlet • audience • bureau • syndication • correspondent • voice

1B • Sort — a person, an institution, or a group of readers?

Three columns. **Two of the twelve belong in two columns and that is the point of the unit.**

columnist • masthead • readership • correspondent • outlet • audience • bureau • editorial • constituency • voice

1C • Meet — the phrases that claim a mandate

speak for	A claim about authority that is almost never examined.
on behalf of	The same claim, in the passive voice of institutions.
our readers	A set nobody has counted, invoked to settle arguments.
the paper's view	A view with no person in it.
the community affected	The group most often written about and least often quoted.

1D • Collocation Lab

Complete each one, and say which of the five is the only one that could be checked.

a named writer • an unsigned piece • local to the story • parachute journalism • whose paper is it

1. The leader page carries _____ every day and has done since 1911.
2. A reporter flown in for three days produces _____, whatever the quality.
3. The stringer is _____ and was not asked to write it.
4. Readers can argue with _____; nobody can argue with an institution.
5. The question under all of this is _____.

1E • The phrasal verbs, and the three fixed expressions

speak up • stand in • write up

f we have always said • f this paper believes • f who is the we here?

Two of these fixed expressions assert and one interrogates. Which, and what does the third one do to the other two?

1F • Own it

Write one sentence beginning *We have always...* about a group you belong to, and then write down the earliest date on which you can prove it.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in} The leader conference — She has a draft that says always. He has the volume for 2017.

2A • The leader conference 📻 Track 2.1

Before you listen. Tomorrow's editorial begins *We have always said*. A researcher has been through the archive.

Listen once. What did the paper actually say in 2017, and what is being claimed now?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	The claim	The archive	Who the we includes
2017			
2021			
today			

Listen again. True or false?

- 1. The paper took the opposite position in 2017. ☐ T ☐ F
- 2. The editorial will carry a byline. ☐ T ☐ F
- 3. Nobody in the room was at the paper in 2017. ☐ T ☐ F
- 4. The researcher is asked to find a form of words. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- 1. *We have always said this.*
- 2. *We said this in 2017.*
- 3. *We had said the opposite, until 2019.*
- 4. *By next year we will have said it for a decade.*

All four are perfects or simples about the same institution. Which one makes a claim about continuity, and which one makes a claim about a point?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 2.2

Thirty seconds at speed. Three jobs.

- 1. The editor says *we* eleven times and stresses it twice. Write the two stressed instances.
- 2. What changes when *we* is stressed?
- 3. One speaker uses *one* where another would use *we*. What does that do to the claim?

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

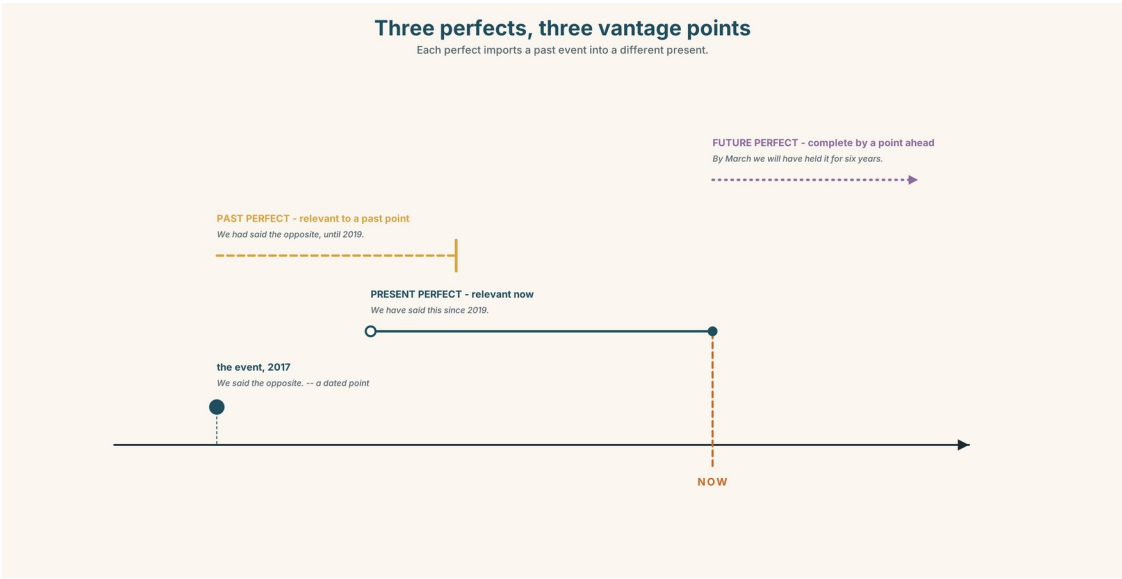
The perfect is a move, not a tense

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

- 1. Which sentence closes the event at a point in the past?
- 2. Which one connects a past event to the present moment, and why is that useful here?
- 3. What does the past perfect in sentence 3 do to the reader's timeline?
- 4. What does the future perfect in sentence 4 allow the writer to assert?

3B • See



Three perfects, three vantage points — Each perfect imports a past event into a different present.

3C • Know

present perfect	the event is relevant now	We have always said this.
past perfect	the event is relevant to	We had said the

	a past point	<i>opposite, until 2019.</i>
future perfect	the event is complete by a future point	<i>By next year we will have said it for a decade.</i>
the discourse function	the perfect imports a past event into the present argument	and that is why institutions like it

The perfect hides the date. *We have always said* contains no year. The simple past requires one, which is why an archive is dangerous to a paper that prefers the perfect.

Inclusive and exclusive we. English does not mark the difference and most languages that do mark it find English maddening here: *we have always said* can mean the institution, the editorial board, the staff, or the staff and the readers together, and the sentence does not say which.

institutional	<i>this paper believes · the paper's view</i>
impersonal	<i>one might say · it is widely held · the general view</i>
personal	<i>speaking personally · the present writer · as a reader</i>
generic	<i>we all know</i> — the most expansive and least checkable

Why it matters. Every piece of persuasive writing places the writer somewhere relative to the reader, and the placement is done almost entirely by pronouns and perfects.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with the most defensible form.

The paper (1) _____ (say) this since 2019, and we (2) _____ (say) the opposite before that. By March we (3) _____ (hold) the position for six years. At the time of the 2017 piece the board (4) _____ (not yet discuss) it. One (5) _____ (might say) that nothing has changed, but the archive disagrees.

3E • Use — guided

Rewrite each one so that the claim is about continuity rather than a point, or the reverse.

1. We took this position in 2019.
2. We have always opposed the plan.
3. The paper had supported it until the inquiry.
4. We will hold this view for a decade by next spring.
5. The board decided in March.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. One of you writes an editorial sentence using *we*. The other asks, four times, *who is the we here?* **Each answer must narrow the set.**

3G • Error autopsy

× *We have said this in 2017.* × *The paper has been believing this since 1911.* × *By the time we published, we have already corrected it.*

For each, name the rule and say what the writer was reaching for.

3H • Check — eight items

1. We ____ (say) this since 2019. (*continuity to now*)
2. We ____ (say) the opposite in 2017. (*a point, dated*)
3. The board ____ (not discuss) it before the piece ran. (*earlier than a past point*)
4. By March we ____ (hold) it for six years. (*complete by a future point*)
5. × *We have said this in 2017.* → correct it.
6. × *The paper has been believing this since 1911.* → correct it.
7. Rewrite *We have always said this* so that it can be checked.
8. Rewrite *This paper believes* so that a named person is responsible.

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — narrow the we

One person makes a claim with *we*. Everybody else asks *who is the we here?* until the speaker names a number of people. **Nobody may answer with another pronoun.**

4B • The functional core — positioning yourself in a text

Two editorials, six years apart
The same page, the same institution, and no name on either of them.

2017

"deserves a hearing" · 0 perfects · 1 date · no byline

today

"we have always opposed it" · 4 perfects · 0 dates · no byline

Find the six. One sentence in the right-hand piece could not be written if the left-hand one carried a date. Which?
6 differences — find them all

{width=6.

6in}

Two editorials, six years apart — The same page, the same institution, and no name on either of them.

Language Bank

the institution

*this paper believes · the paper's view
· on behalf of*

the hedge

it is widely held · the general view ·

the person

one might say

*speaking personally · the present
writer · as a reader*

the challenge

who is the we here? · speak for

Information gap. Learner A has the 2017 editorial. Learner B has today's draft. **Agree on a sentence that both archives can live with.**

4C • The performance — three minutes

Argue a position you hold, in three minutes, **changing your position in the text three times**: once as an institution, once impersonally, and once as yourself. Your partner names each shift as it happens.

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person marks every *we* and writes, beside each, the number of people it includes.

4E • Three criteria

- ☐ Did I make all three positions, and were they audible? ☐ Did every perfect carry a claim about relevance now, not just about the past? ☐ Could my partner name the set behind each *we*?
-

Part 5 • Reading A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**The ward that is always in the paper.**" **Who do you expect to be quoted in a story about a neighbourhood, and who usually is?**

5B • Read — two minutes

The ward that is always in the paper

Ward 7 has appeared in the Herald eighty-one times in two years. The paper has a bureau four kilometres away and has never had a correspondent who lives there.

Of the eighty-one pieces, sixty-two quote a police source, forty-one quote a city councillor, and nine quote somebody who lives in the ward and is not an official. Two of those nine are the same person, who runs a shop on the main street and has now been quoted in four pieces, in each of which he is described as a local resident.

The paper's editorials have said, four times in those two years, that the ward has been neglected. They have not said by whom.

Last month a reporter spent six days in Ward 7 and filed nine hundred words. The readership figures for that piece were the lowest of the month. The eighty other pieces, filed from the bureau in an afternoon, did better.

Nobody at the paper thinks that is an argument. Everybody at the paper knows what it will be used as.

5C • Comprehension — eight questions

- 1. How many times has Ward 7 appeared?
- 2. How far away is the bureau?
- 3. How many pieces quote a resident who is not an official?
- 4. How many of those nine quote the same person?
- 5. What have the editorials said four times?
- 6. Why does the writer point out that the editorials "have not said by whom"?
- 7. What is the function of the perfect in "has now been quoted in four pieces"?
- 8. The last two sentences separate what people think from what will happen. Why end there?

5D • Vocabulary in context

Infer from the text, then check.

a bureau four kilometres away · described as a local resident · neglected · filed from the bureau · what it will be used as

5E • The counter-text

Two leaders, every pronoun marked

Six years apart, on the same page, about the same plan.

LEADER PAGE - 14 MARCH 2017

"The plan deserves a hearing. Our readers in the east end will want to know what it costs, and we will be asking."

LEADER PAGE - TODAY

"We have always opposed this plan. This paper believes the community affected has been neglected, and we have said so throughout."

FEATURE	2017	TODAY
WE / OUR	3	4
PERFECTS	0	4
DATES	1	0
NAMED PEOPLE	0	0
BYLINE	NONE	NONE
POSITION	DESERVES A HEARING	ALWAYS OPPOSED
BOARD MEMBERS THEN	9	9
SAME PEOPLE	--	2 OF 9

WHAT EACH WE CLAIMS

"our readers in the east end"

a set that can be counted

"we will be asking"

the newsroom, about nine people

"we have always opposed"

the institution, since 1911

"we have said so throughout"

unspecifiable

Two of the nine board members are the same people. The word "always" covers a hundred and fourteen years and seven of the nine have changed.

A date, a place, and a promise that can be checked

Four perfects and no dates at all

The perfect count is the whole difference between the two pieces

The first we can be counted. The last cannot

Always is covering a change of seven people out of nine

{width=6.

6in}

Two leaders, every pronoun marked — Six years apart, on the same page, about the same plan.

Read the two editorials — 2017 and today — and answer.

1. What position does each take?
2. **Find every we in both and say what set each one includes.**
3. How many perfects are in each, and what does each perfect import?
4. **Neither editorial has a byline. What would change if one did?**

5F • Two texts

The 2017 editorial says *the plan deserves a hearing*. Today's says *we have always opposed it*.

Is the second sentence false? Write two sentences, and use the word *continuity* in one of them.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Who is included, and who is being spoken about

6A • Sort — includes the reader, excludes the reader, or avoids the question?

Three columns.

inclusive • exclusive • collective • impersonal • generic • institutional • corporate • anonymous

6B • Chunk completion

1. **the _____ we** — the plural used by a single person with authority
2. **one _____ say** — the most distancing construction in formal English
3. **it is widely _____** — a claim with the holders removed
4. **the present _____** — the writer, referring to the writer, in the third person
5. **speaking _____** — the writer stepping out from behind the institution
6. **the general _____** — a consensus nobody has measured

6C • Three that are not interchangeable

in this paper • as a reader • the general view

Say which one claims institutional authority, which claims none, and which claims a consensus.

6D • The phrasal verbs and the fixed expressions

own up • take over • sign off

f speaking for myself • f we take the view that • f that is not our position

One of these fixed expressions can only be said by somebody with authority. Which, and how do you know?

6E • Contrast Clinic

Eight items. Rewrite each sentence so that responsibility moves to the place in brackets.

1. Mistakes were made. (*to a named person*)
2. We have always opposed it. (*to a dated decision*)
3. It is widely held that the plan will fail. (*to the writer*)

4. The paper regrets the error. *(to the desk that made it)*
 5. One might say the figures are unreliable. *(to a named analyst)*
 6. Our readers expect better. *(to a survey, with a number)*
 7. This paper believes in transparency. *(to an editorial board, with a date)*
 8. The community affected was consulted. *(to the three people who were asked)*
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

A stressed pronoun is a contrast
The same sentence, four times, and each stress names somebody who is not in the room.

●	●	●	●	●	
WE	have	al-ways	said	this	and somebody else has not
●	●	●	●	●	
we	HAVE	al-ways	said	this	somebody has denied that we did
●	●	●	●	●	
we	have	AL-ways	said	this	the continuity is the claim being made
●	●	●	●	●	
we	have	al-ways	said	THIS	not the other thing you are accusing us of
●	●	●	●	●	
I	didn't	say	it		a person stepping out
●	●	●	●	●	
WE	said	it			and a body stepping in

{width=6.

6in}

A stressed pronoun is a contrast — The same sentence, four times, and each stress names somebody who is not in the room.

A stressed pronoun is a contrast

7A • Hear 🎧 Track 2.3

WE have always said this. — somebody else has not *We have ALWAYS said this.* — the continuity is the claim *We have always said THIS.* — not the other thing

7B • Say

Say each one three times. Then say this:

I didn't say it. WE said it. — the stress moves responsibility from a person to a body, and that is the whole function of the editorial *we*.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

We take the view that... — unstressed *we*: the institution, routinely *WE take the view that...* — stressed: and somebody else takes a different one

An unstressed pronoun is a reference. A stressed one is a contrast, and the contrast always implies a party who is not in the room.

7D • Fluency 30

Thirty seconds: **one position, stated four times — as the institution, impersonally, as yourself, and as a reader.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

A position, with its holders named • 200 words

8A • Read the model

This paper opposed the Ward 7 plan in a leader on 14 March 2019. [the institution, with a date – the perfect would have hidden it]

We had supported an earlier version of it in 2017, and we were wrong about the costs. [the past perfect places the earlier position, and the admission is in the same sentence]

The present writer was not on the board in 2017 and has read the file. [the person, distinguished from the institution, and a perfect doing proper work]

It is widely held in this building that the ward has been neglected. By whom is a question we have not answered, and by March we will have been asking it for six years. [the impersonal, the challenge to it, and a future perfect that dates the failure]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The first sentence uses a simple past with a date. **What would we have always opposed have cost?**
2. *The present writer* appears once. **Why not I?**
3. The last sentence turns the paper's own phrase against it. **Which word does the work?**

8B • The anti-model

We have always believed that Ward 7 deserves better. Our readers expect this paper to speak for the communities it serves. Mistakes were made in the past but we have learnt from them. This paper believes in accountability.

Four sentences, four unexaminable claims, and not one date or person in any of them. **Rewrite it so that every claim has either a date or a name attached.**

8C • Plan

the institution, with a date → the earlier position, placed → the person, separated → the impersonal claim, and the challenge to it

8D • Write — 200 words

8E • Peer review — three criteria

☐ Does every *we* have a number behind it that the writer could state? ☐ Does every perfect import something into the present argument, or is it hiding a date? ☐ Is there at least one sentence where the writer appears as a person?

8F • Write it again • 8G • Publish

Rewrite after review. **Publish both, and mark every pronoun in both.**

Part 9 • The File ♦ A • THE WORLD + C • THE PERFORMANCE

Four sentences a learner says with we

Each imports a group. Each borrows that group's excuse.

THE WE IN YOUR OWN ACCOUNT - AN AUDIT

THE SENTENCE	THE SET	EVIDENCE
"IN MY COUNTRY WE DON'T SPEAK"	~40 MILLION	ONE SCHOOL
"WE WERE NEVER TAUGHT THIS"	ONE CLASS, 2009-15	MEMORY
"WE ALL HAVE THIS PROBLEM"	UNSPECIFIED	NONE
"WE LEARN DIFFERENTLY"	UNSPECIFIED	NONE

WHAT EACH ONE LICENSES

"we don't speak"	not speaking, indefinitely
"we were never taught"	not learning it now
"we all have this problem"	no action, because it is general
"we learn differently"	rejecting any method that is uncomfortable

THE SAME CLAIMS, NARROWED

Set of one	"I did not speak in class between 2009 and 2015."
With a date	"I have not had a conversation in English since March."

Narrowing does not make the sentence less true. It makes it a description of a situation rather than a description of a people, and a situation is a thing that can be changed this week.

Forty million people, one school, and one person affected

A class that finished a decade ago

No set and no evidence, and the hardest one to argue with

Every one of these is a licence, not a complaint

The narrowed versions are all actionable this week

6in}

Four sentences a learner says with we — Each imports a group. Each borrows that group's excuse.

STUDY FILE • Whose standard are you measuring against?

9A • The we in your own account 📶 Track 2.4

Learners describe their English in the first person plural more often than they notice: *in my country we don't study speaking, we were never taught this, we all have this problem*. Each one imports a group and borrows its excuse.

the claim	<i>we were never taught to speak</i>
the set	about forty million people
the evidence	one school, 2009 to 2015
what it licenses	not speaking, indefinitely

9B • Narrow it

Take three sentences you have said about your English that begin with *we* or *in my country*. Rewrite each with the smallest honest set and a date.

9C • Role play — who is the we here?

In pairs. One of you describes a difficulty using *we*. The other may only ask *who is the we here?* and *since when?* **Four rounds each.**

9D • The inherited position

Everybody has at least one belief about language learning they did not arrive at themselves. **Name yours and name who gave it to you.** Then decide whether you still hold it.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Write the sentence *I have always...* about your English, and then find the earliest evidence. Bring both. Most people find the *always* is about four years old.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



{width=6.

6in}

Ward 7, two years, eighty-one pieces — Who is quoted, who writes, and who the editorials say the paper speaks for.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the archive. Half has the draft. **Produce one sentence both can sign, by speaking only.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one reader

A reader writes: *You say you have always opposed this. I have the 2017 paper in front of me.* **Reply in four sentences.** Do not use the perfect.

10C • Online

Write **one message** to a colleague about a we in their draft that is doing too much work. **Three sentences.** Name the set it is claiming.

10D • Your language

Does your language distinguish an inclusive we from an exclusive one? **Translate *we have always said this both ways*.** Which does the English sentence mean?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

The byline on the leader page

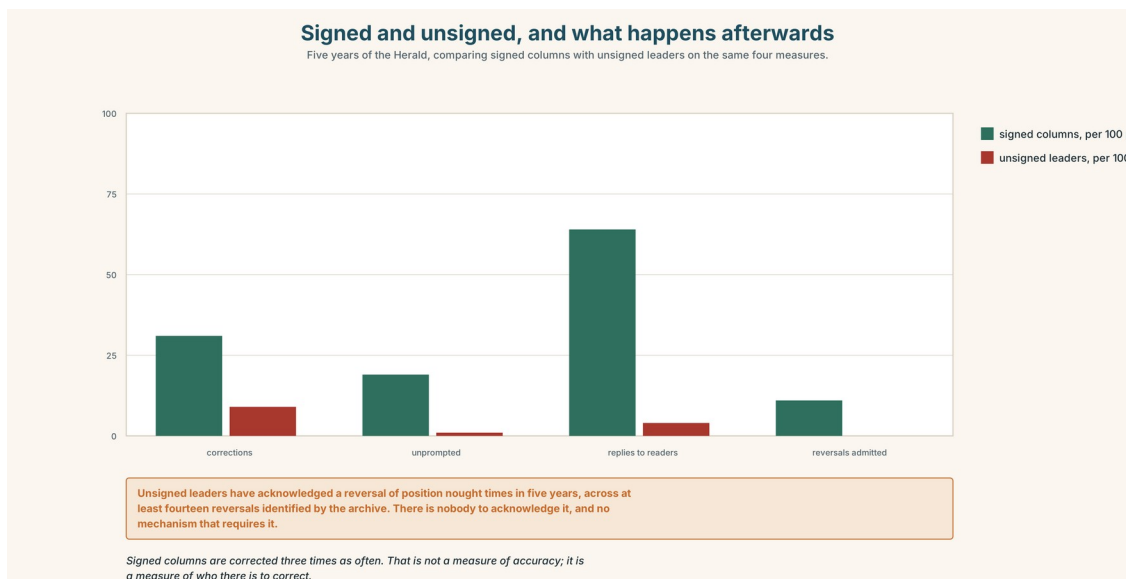
The Herald's editorials have been unsigned since 1911.

Option one: keep it. An unsigned leader is the paper speaking, which is the point of a leader page, and a byline makes it a column.

Option two: sign them. The person who wrote it is named, as everywhere else in the paper, and *we have always said* becomes harder to write.

Option three: keep them unsigned and publish, once a year, the names of everybody who sat on the board and the dates of every position change.

11A • The evidence



{width=6.

6in}

Signed and unsigned, and what happens afterwards — Five years of the Herald, comparing signed columns with unsigned leaders on the same four measures.

Track 2.6. The columnist, 30 seconds: *"I have written under my own name for nineteen years and I have been wrong in public about four things. The leader page has been wrong about rather more and has never apologised, because there is nobody there to apologise. That is not a bug in the system. It is the system."*

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame, and state the set behind every we you use.

I would _____, because _____, and the people affected are _____.

11C • Decide

Write **three sentences**: the decision, the evidence, and who would be accountable under it.

11D • Model decision

Option three. Signing the leader turns it into a column and loses the one thing a leader page can do, which is commit an institution. Publishing the board and the dates keeps the institutional voice and makes *we have always said* checkable — which is the only part of the current arrangement that is doing damage.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The Herald published the board list and the position changes. The leader page stayed unsigned.

Then something nobody predicted: the phrase *we have always said* disappeared from the leader page within four months, without any instruction. Writers who knew a reader could check the date simply stopped reaching for the construction.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

Nobody banned the phrase. What did the list of dates actually change?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — fifteen items

1. We _____ (say) this since 2019. (*continuity to now*)
2. We _____ (say) the opposite in 2017. (*a dated point*)
3. The board _____ (not discuss) it before the piece ran.
4. By March we _____ (hold) it for six years.
5. The _____ we — a single person using a plural with authority
6. _____ might say that nothing has changed.
7. It is widely _____ that the ward has been neglected.
8. The present _____ was not on the board in 2017.
9. _____ personally, I disagree.
10. This paper _____ in accountability.
11. _____ ? (*four words — the challenge*)
12. That is not _____ . (*two words — the institutional refusal*)
13. She was asked to _____ for the editor on Friday. (*two words*)
14. Somebody has to _____ to the error. (*two words*)
15. The piece was _____ overnight by a stringer. (*two words*)

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write 150 words taking a position, in which you appear once as an institution, once impersonally and once as yourself. Mark the three in the margin.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can use the perfect to import a past event into a present argument. **Evidence:** 3H, 8D ☐ I can place myself in a text at three distances. **Evidence:** 4C ☐ I can say what set a *we* includes. **Evidence:** 6E, 9C ☐ I can hear and use contrastive pronoun stress. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Compare.** How many of your inherited opinions did you name the first time?

12E • Glossary — fifty items, as a map

THE PEOPLE · columnist · correspondent · stringer · voice **THE INSTITUTION** · byline · masthead · editorial · outlet · bureau · syndication **THE READERS** · readership · audience · constituency **THE CLAIMS** · speak for · on behalf of · our readers · the paper's view · the community affected **THE DESCRIPTIONS** · a named writer · an unsigned piece · local to the story · parachute journalism · whose paper is it **WHAT PEOPLE DO** · speak up · stand in · write up · own up · take over · sign off **IN THE ROOM** · we have always said · this paper believes · who is the *we* here? **THE REFERENCE** · inclusive · exclusive · collective · impersonal · generic · institutional · corporate · anonymous **THE FORMULAE** · the royal *we* · one might say · it is widely held · the present writer · in this paper · speaking personally · as a reader · the general view **POSITIONING YOURSELF** · speaking for myself · we take the view that · that is not our position

12F • Next

Unit 3 • How sure are you?